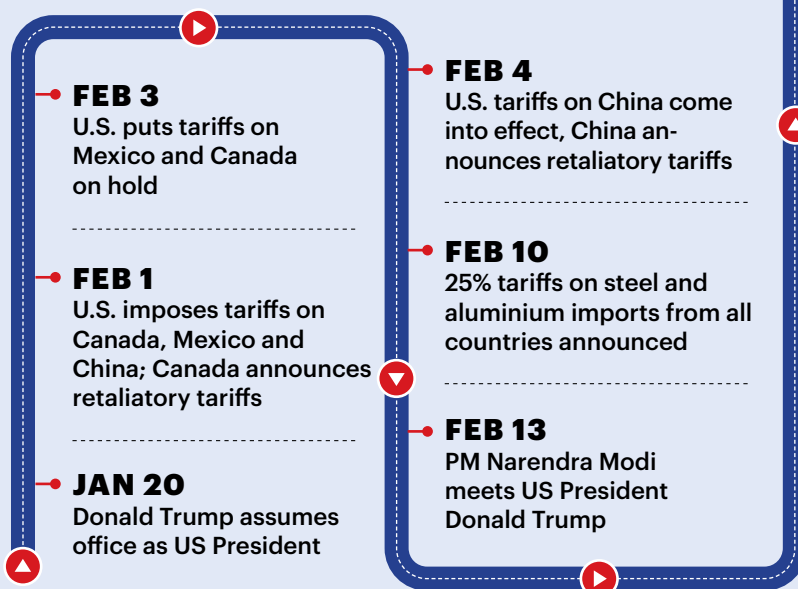




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THE TARIFF WRECK



nearly 60 countries. This included a “discounted” 26% tariff on Indian imports to the US.

While the tariffs on most nations are on hold, Trump’s moves have no doubt led to a new global trade war with increasing uncertainties as the EU and China have levied retaliatory tariffs on the US.

Anup Wadhawan, India’s former commerce secretary, noted that the US was expected to put the tariffs on hold because of pressures from US businesses and consumers on whom the impact would have been catastrophic. India, like others, would now also be at the 10% tariff level and the negotiations would be

the window to get them eliminated. “I am sure the pause will remain beyond 90 days pending negotiations, which should lead to elimination of the 10% tariff in return for some mutual concessions,” he says. The US may give case-by-case exemptions to China based on demands of US industry and eventually find an ac-